

Your advice is sound. It arrives into a system nobody is running.

You draft the trust, and it is never funded. You model the conversion, and the client's advisor sells the wrong lot in the same year. The work was right; **the sequence was nobody's job**. Driftwood exists to hold that seat, and to bring you into the room before the decision is made rather than after.

We do not compete with you. We coordinate around you, and we put your name on the matters that are yours.

Every finding we surface names an owner. When the owner is the attorney or the CPA, that is written down and routed to you, with the context and the modeling already done.

■ What we do

- Read the household as one system: investments, taxes, estate, liquidity, risk, ownership
- Model the decision before it is made, and share the assumptions
- Carry every open matter in a standing register with a status and a named owner
- Bring you the work with the analysis attached, in the year it matters
- Manage the portfolio, tax-aware, when the client wants that too

■ What we never do

- Give tax or legal advice, or opine on your work product
- Move a client's tax or legal work to another firm
- Pay or receive a referral fee of any kind
- Contact your client about anything outside the agreed scope
- Let a decision touch your area without telling you first

WHEN A CLIENT IS WORTH A FIFTEEN-MINUTE CALL

A business sale ahead

Entity structure, QSBS eligibility, and the gifting sequence all set years before closing.

A move between states

Residency reopens income, estate, and trust situs at once. Illinois to Texas is not a small question.

Concentrated stock or equity comp

Bracket management, charitable structures, and basis decisions that interact.

A trust drafted but unfunded

The most common gap we find, and the cheapest to close.

An inheritance or a death in the family

Portability elections are lost by silence, not by decision.

No one coordinating

The client has good advisors who have never spoken to each other.

WHY SEQUENCE IS THE WHOLE ARGUMENT

One composite household, roughly \$8,000,000, an Illinois estate above the state's \$4,000,000 exclusion. Each specialist did good work alone: the attorney drafted an ILIT, the CPA built a conversion ladder, the insurance seat funded a policy. Nothing was wrong. **Nothing was sequenced.**

≈ \$395,000

The difference between those decisions made in isolation and the same decisions made in order. Not a clever instrument any one of us could have named alone.

Hypothetical, for illustration, not an actual client result. Reflects current law, which is subject to change; suitability is specific to each household.

Alec Messino, Founder

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If a review isn't warranted for your client,
we will tell you on the call.

Educational, not investment, tax, or legal advice. Driftwood coordinates with your CPA and attorney; it does not provide tax or legal advice, and pays no compensation for referrals. Driftwood Wealth is the private-wealth practice of Alec Messino. Securities products and advisory services offered through Park Avenue Securities LLC (PAS), member FINRA, SIPC. Alec Messino is a Registered Representative and Financial Advisor of PAS and a Financial Representative of The Guardian Life Insurance Company of America® (Guardian), New York, NY. PAS is a wholly owned subsidiary of Guardian. Capitol Wealth Strategies, LLC is not an affiliate or subsidiary of PAS or Guardian.

What lands on your desk, and when.

Every household we work with runs on one standing register. Each open matter carries a status, an owner, and its dependency, and it stays open until it is resolved and dated. When a matter is yours, this is the form it reaches you in, with the modeling already attached.

MATTER	SYSTEMS	STATUS	OWNER	POTENTIAL
Trust funding & titling	Ownership	Waiting	Estate attorney	structural
Charitable remainder structure, sequenced ahead of the sale	Purpose • Taxes • Estate	Modeling	Driftwood + attorney	\$220,000
Roth conversion window, sized to bracket room	Taxes	Monitoring	Driftwood + CPA	≈ \$4,100/yr
QSBS eligibility ahead of the exit	Taxes • Estate	Open	CPA + attorney	at exit
Asset location tax-drag recovery	Investments • Taxes	Open	Driftwood	≈ \$14,800/yr
Loss carryforward deployment	Taxes	Resolved	Driftwood • Mar 2026	\$11,300 kept

What we send with it

The finding, the mechanism, the assumptions behind any figure, the deadline if one exists, and what we believe the second-order effects are on the systems you do not see. Never a conclusion about your work, and never a client instruction that has not gone through you first.

What we ask of you

Only that we hear about the decision before it is executed rather than at filing. Most of the value in this register comes from sequence, and sequence is only available in advance. A fifteen-minute call is usually enough.

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The register is the product of the relationship. It outlives any single decision.

for referrals.